anti-social elements took over their planned march. Several unions, especially those who were satisfied with the assurances from the government, began to return to their villages. Seeing that the movement was losing steam quickly, the leader of SKM, Rakesh Tikait, shed some tears appealing to the protestors to stay put, breathing life into the protests. In order to take control of the law-and-order situation and avoid a repeat of the events which took place on 26 January, the internet was cut off for a few hours at the protesting sites along the borders of the national capital.

What picked up steam, however, was the media narrative to slander the prime minister and his government. In fact, parallel to the protests losing steam, some sections of the media were fully fired up. Despite the brazen acts on Republic Day, these sections weren't able to untie their blindfolds and wake up to the fact that the movement no longer remained a debate on issues that the farmers were facing. Anti-national, anti-farmer groups had hijacked the protests with an underlying agenda to keep it going as long as possible, and create as much noise as possible. In a week after the deplorable acts on Republic Day, celebrity pop-singer Rihanna tweeted a picture of farmers on a tractor with a question, 'Why aren't we talking about this?#FarmersProtest.'[25] Interestingly, in a matter of minutes, her tweet was retweeted and replied to by several popular people around the world with a clear leaning towards the other side of the ideological line than from the one the current establishment comes from.[26] Global climate activist Greta Thunberg too retweeted Rihanna's tweet attached with a 'toolkit' comprising actions which one could take to support the protestors. Some of the prescribed actions such as organizing protests outside the closest Indian embassy, media house or government office and creating a social media storm on pre-decided dates[27] were clearly aimed to disturb peace within the Indian society. The fact that she deleted this toolkit later stating that it was still being updated by folks on ground was even more suspicious. Popular pornographic actors like Mia Khalifa also got involved in the social media activism siding with the protestors.[28] Several journalists, writers and editors of publishing businesses in India who carry an anti-government imprint took forward the narrative ignited by these international celebrities, turning a blind eye to the extremists' hijack. An interesting pattern began to emerge; freelancing journalists in India tied up with international media outlets and started regularly flushing out content which took forward the narrative painstakingly built by the Opposition. To